



General Assembly

Distr.: General
8 April 2026

Original: English

Eightieth session

Agenda item 158

Financing of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 for the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Appropriation for 2024/25	\$68,791,100
Allotment for 2024/25	\$65,379,200
Expenditure for 2024/25	\$64,732,400
Unencumbered balance for 2024/25	\$4,058,700
Appropriation for 2025/26	\$70,694,100
Projected expenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$60,129,500
Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$10,564,000
Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27	\$62,709,300
Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	(\$156,500)
Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	\$62,552,800

^a Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

^b Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.



I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the report on the financing of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara (MINURSO) ([A/80/600](#)), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses received on 3 March 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report ([A/80/604](#)), and those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report ([A/80/633](#)).

II. Budget performance report for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. By its resolution [78/307](#), the General Assembly appropriated an amount of \$68,791,100 gross (\$65,942,100 net) for the maintenance of the Mission for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. Expenditure for the period totalled \$64,732,400 gross (\$61,754,100 net), for a budget implementation rate of 94.1 per cent due to the net effect of: (a) the increased requirements under military and police personnel, attributable primarily to the higher mission subsistence allowance rates; offset in part by (b) the reduced requirements for civilian personnel, attributable primarily to the application of higher-than-approved vacancy rates; and (c) the reduced requirements for operational costs attributable to the lower actual costs and volume of petrol, oil and lubricants, and the reprioritization of resources in light of liquidity challenges ([A/80/600](#), summary). A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report.

3. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that redeployments in the amount of \$895,400 to group I (military and police personnel) resulted from expenditures in excess of the appropriation primarily due to actual requirements related to higher mission subsistence allowance rates. **The Advisory Committee trusts that more detailed information on redeployments will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report, in particular on activities curtailed and other lower-than-budgeted expenditures that allowed for resources to be redeployed and on criteria used by missions to reprioritize resources.**

4. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that unliquidated obligations amounted to \$5,579,900, or 8.1 per cent, as at 30 June 2025, of the appropriation for the 2024/25 period, representing an increase of \$914,900 compared with the amount of \$4,665,000 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, unliquidated obligations had decreased to \$3,629,300 for the 2024/25 period, comprising military and police personnel (\$6,400), civilian personnel (\$158,800) and operational costs (\$3,464,100).

5. The unencumbered balance, in gross terms, amounts to \$4,058,700, or 5.9 per cent of the total resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report of the Secretary-General on the budget performance of MINURSO for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. As indicated in section II.F of the report, other revenues and adjustments for the 2024/25 period amount to \$917,500, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$7,400); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$56,400), including refund of prior-period expenses (\$500) and other revenue (\$55,900); and (c) the cancellation of prior-period

obligations (\$853,700). The Advisory Committee notes from the report of the Secretary-General (ibid., paras. 43 and 83 (c)) that credits comprising the above-referenced unencumbered balance (\$4,058,700) and other revenue (\$917,500) are proposed to be placed in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates (see para. 36 below).

Matters pertaining to the report of the Board of Auditors

6. In considering the report of the Secretary-General, the Advisory Committee also had before it the report of the Board of Auditors on the accounts of the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2025 (A/80/5 (Vol. II)). In its report, the Board identified weaknesses in fuel management, a significant number of abnormal consumption cases, and opportunities for improvement in data quality and the monitoring of excessive consumption. In addition, \$114,900 in assets transferred from the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali (MINUSMA) were written off as “lost in transit”, with no insurance claim filed, and 37.1 per cent of stock at the Mission was considered as “dead stock”, that is, idle for over one year (A/80/5 (Vol. II), chap. II, paras. 90, 92, 117 and 127). The Board also makes observations on liquidity management (ibid., chap. II, paras. 257, 267, 270 and 275, and chap. IV, para. 12). **The Advisory Committee trusts that MINURSO will file the necessary insurance claims and provide an update on the current status of assets transferred from MINUSMA, as well as further clarification of the challenges in allocation processes that led to some being idle for over one year, to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report. The Committee further trusts that the recommendations of the Board of Auditors will be implemented in a timely manner.**

III. Information on performance for the current period

7. With respect to current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$38,099,000, or 54.0 per cent, of the appropriation of \$70,694,100. At the end of the current period, total expenditure was estimated at \$60,129,500,¹ representing an implementation rate of 85.0 per cent of the appropriation for 2025/26.

8. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that MINURSO had implemented a 15 per cent reduction in expenditure for the 2025/26 period, as follows: under group I, the repatriation of 74 uniformed personnel (47 military observers, 20 military contingent personnel, 5 military staff officers and 2 individual police officers), of which 27 military observers were expected to return to the Mission (see also para. 16 below); under group II, a recruitment freeze for all vacant posts and positions; and under group III, the postponement of projects and deferral of information and communications technology, infrastructure and operational acquisitions due to liquidity challenges. It was indicated to the Committee that mine action activities had been reduced by half, with one team operating instead of two and a deferral of contractor mobilization, leading to an estimated shortfall in cleared land for the period (see also para. 28 below). **The Advisory Committee notes that, while MINURSO has been able to preserve operational continuity at a reduced level and maintain core mandate implementation, liquidity challenges constrained the operational capacity of the Mission. The Committee trusts that all efforts will be**

¹ Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

undertaken to ensure the security and safety of personnel. The Committee also trusts that an update on and a more detailed assessment of the impact of the contingency plan on the implementation of the Mission's mandate will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next performance report.

9. The Advisory Committee notes that, as at 2 February 2026, a total of \$1,738,274,000 had been assessed on Member States in respect of MINURSO since its inception. Payments received as at the same date amounted to \$1,663,306,000, resulting in an outstanding balance of \$74,968,000. The Committee also notes that, as at 2 February 2026, the cash available to the Mission amounted to \$15.6 million, inclusive of \$14.9 million borrowed from the peacekeeping reserve fund in line with resolution [76/272](#), and was \$1.9 million lower than the three-month operating reserve of \$17.5 million. **The Advisory Committee notes that the outstanding contributions of \$75.0 million represent approximately 106 per cent of the appropriation of \$70.7 million for the 2025/26 period. The Committee reiterates its concern regarding the serious and persistent challenge of the cash position of MINURSO and the continued need for the borrowing of funds by the Mission to meet its operational requirements. The Committee recalls that the General Assembly has repeatedly urged all Member States to fulfil their financial obligations as set out in the Charter of the United Nations, on time, in full and without conditions (see resolution [79/310](#), para. 2; see also [A/79/724/Add.8](#), para. 7).**

10. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that, as at 31 December 2025, claims for the reimbursement of troop costs had been settled up to September 2025, leaving an outstanding balance of \$86,900. Contingent-owned equipment had been paid up to December 2024 and certified up to December 2025, leaving an outstanding balance of \$218,600. In addition, one death and disability claim was pending. **The Advisory Committee trusts that all outstanding liabilities and the claim will be settled in a timely manner.**

IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

A. Mandate and planning assumptions

11. The mandate of MINURSO was established by the Security Council in its resolution [690 \(1991\)](#) and extended most recently, until 31 October 2026, in its resolution [2797 \(2025\)](#). The planning assumptions and mission support initiatives for 2026/27 are summarized in section I.C of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/600](#)).

Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency

12. Information on efficiency gains is provided in section II.C of the report of the Secretary-General. The cost estimates for 2026/27 take into account efficiency initiatives under military contingents, civilian personnel, facilities and infrastructure, information and communications technology, and air operations, in the amount of \$5,147,400 (*ibid.*, para. 40). Estimated efficiencies for 2026/27 represent a 7.3 per cent reduction compared to the approved budget for 2025/26, in the context of an overall 11.3 per cent proposed reduction (see para. 14 below). The Secretary-General indicates in his report that, in the context of the UN80 Initiative, the MINURSO proposal reflects efficiency measures including the proposed outsourcing of medical support previously provided by troop- and police-contributing countries to a

commercial provider, to be complemented by MINURSO internal capabilities. The Mission also implemented targeted United Nations police and military staff officer position reductions (A/80/600, para. 27). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that MINURSO had postponed all non-critical information and communications technology, infrastructure and operational activities due to liquidity pressures, which could not be considered an efficiency gain. The proposed reductions under the UN80 Initiative reflect the Mission's deliberate, requirements-based efforts, building on the recalibrated footprint and contingency measures applied in 2025/26, to prioritize mandate-critical activities, streamline structures, align resources and enhance coordination and oversight. Although these efforts have been undertaken while maintaining all mandated activities and team sites, the Committee was informed that reductions would reduce operational flexibility and surge capacity and that sustaining operations would depend on the predictability of resources.

13. **The Advisory Committee notes that, while some proposed reductions reflect structural efficiency gains resulting from process improvements, others are driven primarily by liquidity constraints and temporary expenditure compression. The Committee trusts that further information on the connection between the proposed reductions and changes in the expected accomplishments and outputs proposed for MINURSO for 2026/27 will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, to allow for a better assessment of the sustainability and long-term implications of such measures on the implementation of the mandate of the Mission.** The Committee further discusses efficiency measures in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

B. Resource requirements

14. The total resource requirements in the amount of \$62,709,300 requested for the 2026/27 period represent a decrease of \$7,984,800, or 11.3 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$70,694,100 approved for the 2025/26 period. Decreases are proposed under all categories of the proposed budget (see table below).

Financial resources

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Approved (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
Military and police personnel	7 425.1	8 320.5	8 879.5	4 718.6	7 064.6	(1 814.9)	(20.4)
Civilian personnel	25 334.7	25 157.5	26 196.6	18 093.1	26 620.3	(2 576.3)	(9.8)
Operational costs	36 031.3	31 254.4	35 618.0	15 287.3	32 024.4	(3 593.6)	(10.1)
Gross requirements	68 791.1	64 732.4	70 694.1	38 099.0	62 709.3	(7 984.8)	(11.3)

1. Military and police personnel

<i>Category</i>	<i>Authorized 2024/25</i>	<i>Actual as at 30 June 2025</i>	<i>Authorized 2025/26^a</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Authorized and proposed for 2026/27</i>	<i>Variance</i>
<i>Category</i>	<i>(1)</i>	<i>(2)</i>	<i>(3)</i>	<i>(4)</i>	<i>(5)</i>	<i>(6)=(5)-(3)</i>
Military observers	218	149	218	152	218	–
Military contingent personnel	27	25	27	23	27	–
United Nations police	12	2	12	–	12	–

^a Represents the highest level of authorized strength.

Delayed deployment factors

(Percentage of approved strength)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Budgeted 2024/25</i>	<i>Actual 2024/25</i>	<i>Budgeted 2025/26</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Actual average, 1 July 2025– 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Projected 2026/27</i>
Military and police personnel						
Military observers	11.5	13.3	8.3	30.3	31.7	23.4
Military contingent personnel	–	3.7	–	14.8	11.1	92.6
United Nations police	83.3	83.3	83.3	100.0	91.7	100.0

15. The proposed resources for military and police personnel for 2026/27 reflect a decrease of \$1,814,900, or 20.4 per cent, compared with the apportionment for 2025/26. The proposed decrease is mainly attributable to the non-deployment of the medical military contingent and higher vacancy rates for military observers (A/80/600, summary). The Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that the non-deployment of the medical military unit was made possible by improved local medical infrastructure allowing for the use of commercial services. **The Advisory Committee notes the reduction in medical costs achieved through the use of local medical services and trusts that the Secretary-General will examine the potential for applying similar approaches, where feasible, in other peacekeeping operations.**

16. The Advisory Committee notes that, of the 74 uniformed personnel repatriated in accordance with the contingency plan in the 2025/26 period (see para. 8 above), 27 military observers were expected to return to the Mission. The Committee also notes that, with the application of the proposed delayed deployment factor of 23.4 per cent, the average planned deployment for 2026/27 would correspond to 167 military observers from the authorized level of 218, inclusive of 14 military observers projected to return to the Mission during the period. **The Advisory Committee trusts that further clarification of the planned deployment, including the projected timelines for the repatriation of personnel expected to return to the area of operations, and the proposed delayed deployment factor will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

17. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for military and police personnel.**

2. Civilian personnel

<i>Category</i>	<i>Approved 2024/25</i>	<i>Encumbered as at 30 June 2025</i>	<i>Approved 2025/26</i>	<i>Encumbered as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Proposed 2026/27</i>	<i>Variance</i>
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(5)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)
Posts						
International staff	87	73	87	60	80	(7)
National Professional Officers	2	2	2	2	3	1
National General Service staff	161	149	161	130	144	(17)
Temporary positions						
International staff ^a	1	1	1	1	1	–
United Nations Volunteers	17	13	17	12	17	–
Government-provided personnel	10	–	10	–	10	–
Total	278	239	278	205	255	(23)

^a Funded under general temporary assistance.

18. The proposed resources for civilian personnel for 2026/27 reflect a decrease of \$2,576,300, or 9.8 per cent, compared with the apportionment for 2025/26. The decrease in requirements is primarily attributable to lower requirements under international and national General Service staff, owing primarily to the abolishment of 23 posts and the application of higher vacancy rates for international staff, and offset in part by the weakening of the Moroccan dirham against the United States dollar (*ibid.*, paras. 60 and 62).

Recommendations on posts and positions

19. The Secretary-General proposes a total of 255 civilian posts and positions for 2026/27, reflecting a net decrease of 23 posts and positions compared with the staffing approved for 2025/26. Six international posts and 17 national posts (1 P-5, 1 P-4, 2 P-3, 2 Field Service and 17 national General Service) are proposed for abolishment, as outlined in the report (A/80/600, summary, paras. 33 and 36, and second table). It is proposed to maintain one general temporary assistance position of Programme Management Officer (P-4) established on 1 July 2022 to support the MINURSO mine action programme. In addition, it is proposed to nationalize one post of Public Information Officer (P-3) as a post of Associate Public Information Officer (National Professional Officer), reflecting the availability of qualified national strategic information expertise (*ibid.*, paras. 33–36 and second table). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that no nationalization measures had been implemented by the Mission in the past five years due to the operational and security environment, necessitating the deployment of international staff. The Committee was further informed that MINURSO was due to conduct a civilian staffing review in 2026 that would guide the Mission's staffing configuration, including on further nationalization options and the rationalization of functions. **The Advisory Committee recalls General Assembly resolution 76/274 and its earlier observation (A/79/724/Add.8, para. 15) and considers that, as a matter of principle, the Secretary-General should ensure the continuous optimization of the staffing structures, including through civilian and security staffing reviews, with the aim of identifying efficiencies that will be reflected in the next budget proposal. The Committee also recalls paragraph 34 of General Assembly resolution 76/274 (see also A/78/744, para. 37) and is of the view that more efforts should be made to nationalize functions commensurate with mission mandates**

and requirements, wherever appropriate. The Committee further discusses civilian staffing reviews in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

Vacant posts

20. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, 63 posts were vacant (2 D-1, 2 P-5, 6 P-4, 6 P-3, 11 Field Service, 31 national General Service and 5 United Nations Volunteers) and that 4 posts (1 Field Service and 3 national General Service) had been vacant for more than two years, of which 2 national General Service posts were proposed for abolishment. Recruitment and selection for the remaining national General Service post had been completed in February 2026, but the exceptional approval of recruitment of the recommended candidate had been suspended due to the impact of the liquidity situation. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the number of vacant posts and their recruitment status will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission. The Committee trusts that the remaining long-vacant posts will continue to be critically reviewed in the context of the next budget submission.** The Committee discusses vacant and long-vacant posts in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

21. The Advisory Committee was also informed, upon enquiry, that nine posts (1 P-4, 1 P-3, 5 Field Service and 2 national General Service) were encumbered by staff with approved requests for early separation as at 31 December 2025. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on all staff of the Mission approved for the early separation programme, as well as on the related costs, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Vacancy rates

Vacancy rates

(Percentage)

Category	Budgeted 2024/25	Actual 2024/25	Budgeted 2025/26	Actual as at 31 December 2025	Actual average, January– December 2025	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average July 2025– February 2026	Proposed 2026/27
Civilian personnel								
International staff	9.2	11.5	9.2	18.4	14.9	31.0	19.5	11.3
National staff								
National Professional Officers	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
National General Service staff	8.1	8.1	8.1	18.0	8.7	19.3	12.4	8.3
United Nations Volunteers								
International staff	17.6	17.6	11.8	29.4	23.5	29.4	29.4	23.5
General temporary assistance								
International	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Government-provided personnel	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

22. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information on the latest actual and actual average vacancy rates to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, along with clear justification where the proposed rates differ from the actual rates, including as it relates to the impact of proposed abolishments and realistic**

projected recruitment and potential upcoming vacancies, to the extent possible (see also [A/79/724/Add.8](#), para. 16).

23. The Advisory Committee recommends approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian staff.

3. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)	(7)=(6)÷(3)
Operational costs							
Civilian electoral observers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Consultants and consulting services	48.8	4.9	14.8	9.7	14.8	—	—
Official travel	521.8	350.4	579.6	149.4	545.9	(33.7)	(5.8)
Facilities and infrastructure	5 305.3	3 656.1	5 525.4	1 609.8	5 138.3	(387.1)	(7.0)
Ground transportation	1 757.8	1 306.0	2 136.1	544.9	1 491.5	(644.6)	(30.2)
Air operations	20 175.0	18 619.1	17 887.8	8 694.7	16 137.8	(1 750.0)	(9.8)
Marine operations	95.0	9.3	57.0	—	32.4	(24.6)	(43.2)
Communications and information technology	2 796.0	2 500.7	3 252.3	1 274.4	3 125.6	(126.7)	(3.9)
Medical	263.4	145.6	221.4	38.2	217.1	(4.3)	(1.9)
Special equipment	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Other supplies, services and equipment	5 068.2	4 662.3	5 943.6	2 968.5	5 321.0	(622.6)	(10.5)
Quick-impact projects	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Subtotal	36 031.3	31 254.4	35 618.0	15 287.3	32 024.4	(3 593.6)	(10.1)

24. The proposed resources for operational costs for 2026/27 represent a decrease of \$3,593,600, or 10.1 per cent, compared with the resources approved for 2025/26. The proposed decrease reflects reduced requirements under all budget classes, with the exception of consultants and consulting services.

Official travel

25. A provision of \$545,900 is proposed for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$33,700, or 5.8 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$579,600 for 2025/26. The Advisory Committee notes an expenditure of \$350,400 against the appropriation of \$521,800 in the 2024/25 period and \$571,800 in the 2023/24 period. **The Advisory Committee emphasizes that greater use of on-the-job training, virtual meetings, online platforms and online training tools should be made and reiterates its view that travel for conferences, workshops and professional meetings should be kept to a minimum in order to achieve efficiencies (see [A/79/724/Add.8](#), para. 20). Taking also into account the pattern of expenditures, the Committee recommends a reduction of 10 per cent (\$58,000) to the proposed amount under official travel.**

Facilities and infrastructure

26. A provision of \$5,138,300 is proposed for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$387,100, or 7.0 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$5,525,400 for 2025/26. Expenditure in 2024/25 amounted to \$3,656,100 against the appropriation of \$5,305,300 and in 2023/2024 amounted to \$4,049,200 against the appropriation of \$6,060,900. The Secretary-General indicates in his report that the decrease relates mainly to the non-acquisition of equipment owing to MINUSMA transfers and lower projected diesel fuel requirements, offset in part by requirements to replace batteries for photovoltaic systems ([A/80/600](#), para. 71). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that no major construction projects were proposed for the 2026/27 period. **Taking into account the pattern of expenditure, the Advisory Committee recommends a reduction of 2 per cent (\$98,500) to the proposed provision under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol, oil and lubricants.**

Ground transportation

27. A provision of \$1,491,500 is proposed for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$644,600, or 30.2 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$2,136,100 for 2025/26. The Secretary-General indicates in his report that the decrease is due mainly to the lower number of replacement vehicles and lower estimates for average fuel prices and volume compared with 2025/26 (*ibid.*, para. 73). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, while the budget proposal for 2026/27 included the replacement of only six mission-critical vehicles, deferred vehicle replacement from previous periods remained operationally necessary and that the Mission continued to mitigate the associated risks through enhanced maintenance, asset redistribution and close monitoring of fleet reliability pending future replacement, subject to financial capacity and mandate requirements. The Mission would also review the list of available transport equipment of the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) once it became available and would consider requesting the replacement of the corresponding equipment based on the assessment. **The Advisory Committee trusts that, in addressing its vehicle replacement requirements in the context of ongoing liquidity constraints, the Mission will continue to explore opportunities to utilize available vehicles from UNIFIL and other missions, as appropriate.**

Other supplies, services and equipment

28. A provision of \$5,321,000 is proposed for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$622,600, or 10.5 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$5,943,600 for 2025/26. The Secretary-General indicates in his report that the decrease relates mainly to the absence of mobilization and equipment costs which were provided for in the 2025/26 budget related to the onboarding of a new partner under the Mine Action Service (*ibid.*, para. 82). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that one mine action team was deployed east of the berm, representing a 50 per cent reduction in capacity due to liquidity challenges in 2025/26, and that two teams were provisioned for 2026/27 and would be utilized should liquidity be available. Notwithstanding expanded access and continued operations, reductions in mine action capacity in 2025/26 would result in lower clearance and surveys, and the Mission did not expect to achieve its annual target of 2 million m² of cleared land. **The Advisory Committee recalls that the second phase of the phased review and redesign of mine action programmes across the Secretariat is scheduled for 2026/27 (see [A/79/724/Add.8](#), para. 31). The Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information in this regard to the General Assembly in the context of its consideration of the present report.**

Petrol, oil and lubricants

29. For petrol, oil and lubricants, a total amount of \$2,043,500 is proposed for the 2026/27 period, amounting to a decrease of \$479,400, or 19.0 per cent, and reflecting lower fuel costs under air operations (\$1,512,400, a decrease of \$207,800 or 12.1 per cent), ground transportation (\$318,200, a decrease of \$107,600 or 25.3 per cent) and facilities and infrastructure (\$212,900, a decrease of \$164,100 or 43.5 per cent). **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.** The Committee further discusses fuel costs and management in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

30. **Subject to its recommendations in paragraphs 25 and 26 above, the Advisory Committee recommends approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.**

V. Other matters

Environmental initiatives

31. The Secretary-General indicates in his report that the Mission has implemented renewable energy initiatives to improve energy efficiency and reduce reliance on diesel generators at remote team sites. Solar-diesel hybrid power systems with a combined capacity of approximately 700 kW are currently operating at six team sites, generating significant fuel savings, while infrastructure has been completed for an additional 100 kW system at the Agwanit team site east of the berm. The Mission also plans to procure an additional solar system for the Tifariti team site and deploy stand-alone solar streetlights to improve safety and operational efficiency ([A/80/600](#), paras. 10 and 26). It is also indicated that some of the facilities and infrastructure requirements relate to the replacement of batteries associated with the solar power systems installed at team sites, which are necessary to store solar-generated electricity and ensure the continued reliability of the hybrid power systems, particularly given the harsh environmental conditions at the Mission (*ibid.*, para. 71). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the photovoltaic systems deployed at the six remote team sites and the communications repeater site near Laayoune now supply about 90 per cent of 24/7 electricity demand, which has significantly reduced generator operating hours and overall diesel consumption and has enhanced energy reliability at remote sites. Consequently, fuel deliveries and transport movements have decreased, reducing the utilization of fuel trucks and the logistics workload. Reduced generator use has also improved asset longevity, lowered maintenance needs and reduced technician deployments. The planned replacement of obsolete batteries would further improve system efficiency and storage capacity by increasing lifespan and charge-discharge capacity by 50–80 per cent. Regarding the related efficiency gains under the facilities and infrastructure budget class, an investment of \$3,766,000 and cumulative efficiency gains of \$1,700,000 have been recorded since inception, including the projections for the 2026/27 period (*ibid.*, para. 40 and sixth table). **The Advisory Committee notes the efforts of MINURSO to improve its environmental footprint and that efficiency gains have not yet offset investments. The Committee trusts that further efficiency gains will continue to be generated from the photovoltaic power plants, as well as other environmental initiatives, and will be reflected in future reports.** The Committee further discusses environmental activities and energy efficiency in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

Management of sea containers

32. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 16 February 2026, MINURSO held 480 sea containers. Over the past year, the Mission has undertaken targeted measures to strengthen container management, including the systematic review of container contents and the disposal of obsolete materials and aged or unserviceable items, including all electronic waste. These include conversion into mobile control rooms and battery rooms supporting photovoltaic solar systems, security bunkers, field offices and workshops, and security observation posts, and integration with masonry structures to serve as secure storage facilities and archive rooms. Containers are also utilized as interim storage for obsolete materials and ageing equipment pending inspection, disposal, or return to logistics providers. At several locations, containers have been refurbished to address rusting and weather-related deterioration, thereby extending their service life and enhancing structural safety. The Committee discusses the management of sea containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

Equitable geographical representation and gender parity

33. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, MINURSO comprised 193 staff at all levels. Among the 61 international staff, 37 nationalities were represented. Of the total 193 staff, 141 (73 per cent) were male, and 52 (27 per cent) were female.²

34. International MINURSO staff were from the following regional groups: African States (20), Asia-Pacific States (17), Eastern European States (9) and Western European and other States (8), as well as from the United States of America (5) and others (2).

35. **The Advisory Committee trusts that MINURSO will further pursue its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity within the Mission.** The Advisory Committee further discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

VI. Conclusion

36. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of MINURSO for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/600](#)). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$4,058,700 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue amounting to \$917,500 from investment revenue (\$7,400), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$56,400) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$853,700) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

² Detailed and updated information on the nationalities of staff in MINURSO is available on the United Nations Secretariat Workforce Portal.

37. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of MINURSO for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/600). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$156,500, from \$62,709,300 to \$62,552,800. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$62,552,800 for the maintenance of the Mission for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027. A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Committee with regard to the financing of MINURSO for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in the table below.**

Budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

<i>Category</i>	<i>Paragraph number (present report)</i>	<i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>	<i>Financial implication (United States dollars)</i>
Operational costs			
Official travel	25	Reduction of 10 per cent to the proposed amount	(58 000)
Facilities and infrastructure	26	Reduction of 2 per cent to the proposed provision under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol, oil and lubricants	(98 500)
Total			(156 500)